

Customer Support, Tracking & Booking Reference

How customers book, track, and get help with an Allcargo shipment — platforms, processes, and FAQs

1. The Customer Journey, End to End

A customer's interaction with Allcargo generally follows a predictable sequence regardless of which service line is involved: a booking is made, the shipment moves through pickup, transit, and — where applicable — customs clearance, and the customer expects to be able to check status at any point along the way and reach a human being if something goes wrong. Support and tracking questions are rarely about the underlying logistics itself; they are almost always about visibility into a process the customer cannot otherwise see, which is why a fast, accurate status answer resolves the large majority of support contacts on its own.

This reference covers the booking process, the ECU360 digital platform used for tracking and self-service, the domestic express delivery experience including cash-on-delivery, and the support and escalation channels available when a customer needs help beyond what self-service can provide.

It is worth being explicit about why this reference exists as its own document rather than folding these topics into the service-line descriptions covered elsewhere. Booking, tracking, and support are not themselves a service line the way international freight forwarding or contract logistics are — they are the customer-facing layer that sits on top of every service line at once. A question about how to track a shipment is functionally identical whether the underlying cargo is an LCL consolidation bound overseas or a domestic express parcel, which is why this reference is organized around the customer's actual experience of interacting with the company rather than around any single business line's internal operations.

2. Making a Booking

A booking is the formal request that initiates a shipment, capturing the origin and destination, the cargo description and volume or weight, the service type required — LCL, FCL, air freight, or domestic express — and the customer's chosen Incoterm where the shipment is international. Once a booking is confirmed, it is assigned a booking reference, which is the single identifier a customer should use for every subsequent tracking, support, or documentation query concerning that shipment.

Information Needed to Book a Shipment

- bullet Origin and destination addresses, including whether pickup or delivery is required at the door or at a terminal.
- bullet Cargo description, including whether the goods fall into a special handling category such as hazardous (DG) cargo, over-dimensional cargo (ODC), or temperature-controlled goods.
- bullet Total weight and volume, or container count for an FCL booking.
- bullet Preferred service type — LCL consolidation, FCL, air freight, or domestic express — and any specific transit time requirement.
- bullet For international shipments, the agreed Incoterm and the party responsible for arranging carriage and insurance under that term.

Special cargo categories deserve particular attention at the booking stage rather than being discovered later, since hazardous, over-dimensional, or temperature-controlled cargo requires specific equipment, documentation, and sometimes advance regulatory notice that a standard booking does not trigger automatically. A booking that omits this detail can result in the wrong equipment being allocated, which is one of the more avoidable causes of a delay at the pickup stage.

Booking Confirmation and Lead Times

Once a booking is submitted, it moves through a confirmation step before it is treated as a firm shipment: space is checked against the requested service type and departure window, and for LCL consolidation specifically, the booking is matched against the consolidation schedule for the relevant trade lane, since an LCL shipment only moves once enough cargo has been gathered to justify loading that consolidation run. This is an important distinction for a customer comparing LCL against FCL timing: an FCL booking generally moves on a fixed schedule tied to vessel departures, while an LCL booking's actual departure can shift slightly depending on how quickly the consolidation for that specific lane fills.

Lead time — the gap between booking confirmation and actual pickup or vessel departure — varies by service type and route, and a customer asking why one booking moved faster than a similar one previously is often seeing the practical effect of this variability rather than an inconsistency in service. Air freight bookings generally have the shortest lead times given the frequency of flight schedules, FCL bookings follow a fixed vessel schedule known at the time of booking, and LCL bookings carry the most schedule variability since they depend on consolidation timing specific to that lane and week.

Cancellations and Changes to a Confirmed Booking

A booking can generally be amended or cancelled before pickup with comparatively little friction, since no physical movement has yet occurred. Once a shipment has been picked up, and particularly once it has departed on its first transport leg, a change request — to routing, consignee, or delivery instructions — becomes materially more complex, since it may require re-issuing transport or customs documentation already filed under the original instructions. This is why post-departure change requests are treated as a support escalation rather than a self-service action: they typically require manual coordination with the carrier, the CFS or ICD handling the shipment, and in some cases customs, rather than a simple record update.

3. Tracking a Shipment — The ECU360 Platform

ECU360 is Allcargo's digital platform for online booking, real-time shipment tracking, and supply-chain visibility, relaunched in 2017 as part of the company's broader digital-transformation push. For any customer asking how to check the status of a shipment, ECU360 is the primary self-service answer, and it should be the first thing offered before a support escalation is considered.

What ECU360 Shows

- bullet Current shipment status — booked, in transit, at customs, out for delivery, or delivered.
- bullet Milestone history — the sequence of events the shipment has already passed through, such as pickup, port departure, or arrival at a transshipment point.
- bullet Estimated time of arrival (ETA), updated as new schedule or routing information becomes available.
- bullet Document access, where applicable, for shipment-related paperwork the customer is entitled to view directly.

A customer's shipment status should always be checked against ECU360 or the underlying shipment record before any other explanation is offered, since a status that looks unusual to a customer — for instance, a shipment that has not moved in several days — often has a specific, checkable reason attached to it, such as a customs examination or a scheduled transshipment wait, rather than being an unexplained gap in the system.

Proactive Notifications

Beyond on-demand tracking, ECU360 supports proactive status notifications tied to key milestones — booking confirmation, pickup completion, departure, arrival at destination, and out-for-delivery status — so that a customer does not need to actively check the platform to know when their shipment reaches an important stage. This matters for support volume specifically: a customer who has received a proactive notification confirming, for example, that their shipment has cleared customs is far less likely to submit a status enquiry than one who has received no update at all, even if both shipments are progressing identically. Encouraging a customer to enable notifications for a specific shipment is often a more durable fix for repeated status-checking behavior than answering the same status question multiple times in a row.

Document Access Through the Platform

Where applicable, ECU360 gives customers direct access to shipment-related documentation they are entitled to view, such as a copy of the Bill of Lading once issued, or the commercial invoice submitted at booking. This self-service document access is the appropriate first response to a customer asking for a copy of a specific document, rather than routing the request to a support agent to email manually, since the platform copy is both faster for the customer to obtain and guaranteed to be the current version on file.

4. Domestic Express Delivery and Cash-on-Delivery

Allcargo's domestic express distribution business, built on the former Gati network now fully merged into the parent company, provides surface and air express delivery across India, including door-to-door delivery and cash-on-delivery (COD) services. COD allows a recipient to pay for goods at the point of delivery rather than in advance, which is a common requirement for e-commerce and retail shipments where the buyer and seller do not have an established payment relationship.

A COD shipment carries one additional dependency beyond a standard prepaid delivery: the delivery cannot be completed, and the shipment cannot be marked delivered, until the recipient actually makes the required payment to the delivery agent. A COD shipment showing as “out for delivery” for longer than expected is often waiting on the recipient to be available and ready to pay, rather than experiencing any problem with the shipment itself. Multiple failed delivery attempts on a COD shipment are typically handled under a defined re-attempt policy before the shipment is returned to the sender, and a customer asking about a stalled COD delivery should be checked against this re-attempt status specifically.

The last-mile delivery fleet used for domestic express delivery includes an electric-vehicle component, which Allcargo has highlighted as part of its sustainability commitments — the company describes itself as the first Indian logistics company to onboard more than 100 electric vehicles for first- and last-mile delivery specifically.

Delivery windows for domestic express shipments are typically communicated as part of the out-for-delivery notification rather than fixed at the time of booking, since the exact sequence in which a delivery agent reaches individual addresses on a route depends on real-time factors such as traffic and the number of stops already completed that day. A recipient expecting a delivery on a specific day should

generally treat the out-for-delivery status itself as the more reliable signal that delivery is imminent, rather than relying solely on an estimated window communicated earlier in the shipment's journey, since that earlier estimate is naturally less precise the further in advance it was given.

5. Support Channels and When to Escalate

Most customer questions — status checks, ETA queries, and general process questions — are resolved through self-service tracking on ECU360 without needing to reach a support agent at all. A smaller set of situations genuinely require a human to get involved, and recognizing which category a question falls into is central to giving a customer an efficient path to resolution rather than looping them through self-service tools that were never going to answer their specific problem.

Available Support Channels

Beyond the chatbot and the ECU360 self-service platform, customers can typically reach Allcargo through a dedicated customer support phone line and email channel for account or shipment-specific queries, and, for customers with an active relationship at a specific CFS, ICD, or logistics park, through a direct point of contact at that facility for site-specific coordination such as scheduling a pickup slot or arranging an inspection visit. Each channel is best suited to a different kind of query: phone support is generally fastest for time-sensitive issues such as an imminent delivery problem, email is appropriate for documentation requests or non-urgent account matters, and facility-level contacts are most relevant when a customer's question concerns physical activity at a specific location rather than the shipment's overall status.

Response time expectations differ meaningfully across these channels, and setting the right expectation up front avoids a customer feeling ignored simply because they chose a slower channel for an urgent matter. Phone support is generally the fastest path for anything time-sensitive, since it connects the customer to an agent in real time rather than queuing a written request. Email queries are typically handled within a standard business-day turnaround, which is appropriate for documentation requests or account questions but poorly suited to a same-day delivery problem. A customer whose question is genuinely urgent — for instance, a delivery attempt happening later the same day — should generally be directed to phone support rather than email, purely on the basis of how quickly each channel can realistically respond, independent of which channel the customer happened to use first.

Situations Best Resolved Through Self-Service

- bullet Checking current shipment status or estimated arrival.
- bullet Confirming which service type or documents a booking requires.
- bullet General questions about a service line, such as whether Allcargo handles a specific cargo type or route.

Situations That Should Be Escalated to a Human Agent

- bullet A shipment held at customs beyond the routine clearance window, particularly where a document correction or additional certificate is needed.
- bullet Cargo damage or loss reported by the recipient.
- bullet A COD shipment with repeated failed delivery attempts approaching the return-to-sender threshold.
- bullet Any dispute over a demurrage, detention, or storage charge the customer believes was applied incorrectly.

bullet A request involving a change to shipment routing, consignee, or delivery instructions after the shipment has already departed.

The distinguishing feature across the escalation list is that each situation requires a judgment call, an exception to standard process, or access to information and authority that self-service tracking does not provide. A support agent handling an escalated case should always have the shipment's full booking reference and current ECU360 status in hand before beginning, since re-confirming basic status is the most common avoidable delay in an otherwise straightforward escalation.

It is worth handling the boundary between self-service and escalation deliberately rather than defaulting toward escalation whenever a customer sounds frustrated. A customer who is upset about a delay they can already see explained on ECU360 — for instance, a shipment held for a routine customs examination — is usually better served by a clear, specific explanation of what that status means and what happens next, rather than being routed to a support agent who will ultimately give the same explanation after a longer wait. Escalation should be reserved for cases where the platform genuinely cannot resolve the question on its own, not used as a default response to frustration when the underlying information is already available.

6. Multi-Leg Shipments and Combined Visibility

Many shipments, particularly international ones, involve more than one physical leg and, in some cases, more than one Allcargo entity handling different parts of the journey — for example, a domestic pickup leg handled through the express distribution network, an international ocean leg booked through ECU Worldwide as the NVOCC, and a final domestic delivery leg at the destination country handled by a local partner or agent. From the customer's point of view, this should still present as a single, continuous shipment under one booking reference, even though several distinct operational handoffs are happening behind that single view.

Understanding this multi-leg structure matters for explaining certain kinds of status question accurately. A shipment that shows as having arrived at a port but not yet moved further is often simply between legs — waiting for the next carrier, mode, or handling party to take custody — rather than stalled due to a problem. Similarly, a status update that appears to originate from a different system or format than the customer is used to seeing may reflect a handoff to a different operational system at that leg boundary, particularly at an international-to-domestic transition, rather than an error in tracking. When a customer's question concerns a specific leg of a longer journey, it is worth clarifying which leg they mean before answering, since the same overall shipment can be simultaneously fully on schedule for one leg and genuinely delayed for another.

7. Cargo Claims and Returns

A claim arises when a customer reports cargo damage, shortage, or loss and seeks compensation under the shipment's insurance or liability terms. The claims process generally begins with the customer documenting the condition of the cargo at the point damage or shortage is discovered — ideally before the goods are moved further or repackaged, since the physical evidence at the point of discovery is central to assessing the claim. A claim is then filed with supporting documentation: the original packing list and commercial invoice to establish what was shipped, photographs or a discrepancy report describing the damage or shortage, and, where available, a note of any visible damage to the container or packaging itself.

Claims are handled under the specific insurance and liability terms attached to that shipment, which can vary depending on whether the customer carried supplementary cargo insurance beyond the carrier's standard liability coverage. This is why a claims query is always escalated to a support agent rather than answered generically: the applicable compensation depends on the specific coverage in place for that shipment, not on a single fixed company-wide policy.

Returns, distinct from damage claims, arise when a domestic express delivery cannot be completed — most commonly a cash-on-delivery shipment following repeated failed delivery attempts, as described in Section 4 — or when a recipient declines a delivery outright. A returned shipment is routed back to the original sender under the reverse leg of the same express network used for outbound delivery, and the sender should be notified of the return along with the reason recorded for the failed or declined delivery.

Claims handling differs somewhat between international and domestic shipments, reflecting the different liability frameworks each operates under. An international shipment moved under a Bill of Lading is typically subject to the carrier liability limits set out in the applicable international carriage convention for that mode of transport, which caps compensation at a set amount per unit of weight unless the shipper has separately declared a higher value and paid an additional premium to cover it. A domestic express shipment is instead governed by Allcargo's own domestic terms of carriage, which may offer a different default liability structure. A customer with genuinely high-value cargo should be advised, at the time of booking rather than after a loss has already occurred, to consider a declared value arrangement or supplementary insurance appropriate to the mode of transport being used, since the default liability limit attached to a shipment is rarely sufficient to cover the full replacement cost of high-value goods.

Across every topic in this reference, the same underlying principle applies: a customer's question is best answered by first establishing exactly where their shipment currently stands — which leg of the journey it is on, what its current ECU360 status shows, and whether the situation is a routine part of the process or a genuine exception. The large majority of support contacts are resolved simply by surfacing information that already exists in the shipment record, and the smaller set of situations that require escalation are distinguished specifically by needing a judgment call or an exception to standard process that self-service tracking cannot provide on its own.

This guide is a summary reference for customer support and tracking practice. Specific booking requirements, service availability, and support contact channels should be confirmed against current Allcargo and ECU360 platform documentation before being presented to a customer as definitive.